Process Definition Document (PDD)

Project 4: R-Block Financial Reporting Automation

Purpose: Define the business process and requirements for automating financial report extraction and distribution across multiple company codes using Automation Anywhere A360.

1. Business Background

The finance team prepares recurring reports for multiple company codes. The existing process involves manual extraction, repeated navigation and checking, company-code selection, consolidation or formatting, and distribution. A review of the process identified more than eight redundant manual steps. The proposed automation standardizes the workflow and is intended to reduce the overall reporting cycle time by about 50%, subject to validation against the agreed baseline.

2. Objectives

- Reduce repetitive manual effort in recurring financial reporting.
- Extract report data for the approved company codes using a consistent workflow.
- Apply company-code mapping and validation rules before reports are distributed.
- Reduce the reporting cycle time by approximately 50% against the measured baseline.
- Improve consistency, traceability and timely delivery of reports.

3. Scope

In scope

- Review of the current reporting process and gap analysis.
- Scheduled or user-triggered execution of the Automation Anywhere A360 bot.
- Navigation to approved finance systems or reporting sources.
- Selection of company codes and reporting periods based on approved configuration.
- Extraction, validation and organization of report outputs.
- Company-code mapping, output naming, storage and distribution.
- Run logging, exception reporting and completion notifications.

Out of scope

- Changing financial source transactions or posting journal entries.
- Changing accounting policy, financial calculations or report definitions without finance approval.
- Approving or signing off financial results on behalf of the finance team.
- Distributing reports to recipients who are not approved by the report owner.
- Automating systems, company codes or reports not included in the signed-off scope.

4. Stakeholders and Responsibilities

Stakeholder	Responsibility
Finance process owner	Confirms reporting requirements, company codes, periods, report format and acceptance criteria.
Finance users / reviewers	Validate report accuracy and review exceptions before

	use.
RPA developer	Builds, tests, documents and supports the A360 automation.
IT / application support	Maintains system access, runtime environment and application availability.
Information security	Reviews credentials, access permissions, storage and distribution controls.
Report recipients	Receive reports according to the approved distribution list and access rules.

5. Inputs and Outputs

Category	Details
Inputs	Approved source system, report names, company-code list, reporting period, extraction parameters and distribution list.
Reference data	Company-code mapping, output naming convention, report validation rules and approved storage locations.
Outputs	Extracted financial reports, run summary, exception list and execution log.
Delivery	Approved secure folder, finance reporting repository or email distribution, as authorized.

6. Current Process and Gap Analysis

The current process is understood to include repeated manual actions across company codes. The detailed step count and exact task sequence should be confirmed with process walkthroughs and observation.

Observed / potential gap	Proposed improvement
Repeated navigation and report retrieval	Use a reusable A360 workflow for approved report paths.
Manual company-code selection	Drive selections from a validated configuration or mapping table.
Repeated file naming and saving	Apply a standard naming convention and controlled output path.
Manual completeness checks	Validate required files, expected company codes and reporting period.
Manual distribution steps	Deliver only validated outputs to the approved

	recipient list.
Limited run traceability	Record timestamps, processed codes, file counts and exceptions.

7. High-Level Process Flow

1. Start the bot at the agreed schedule or approved manual trigger.
2. Load the reporting configuration, company-code mapping and distribution settings.
3. Validate that the reporting period, company-code list and required configuration are present.
4. Open the approved finance system or reporting source using authorized access.
5. Select each company code and reporting period according to the configuration.
6. Run the report and extract or download the output.
7. Validate the output for expected file presence, naming, period and basic completeness.
8. Save each report to the approved location using the standard naming convention.
9. Create a run summary and exception list for any missing, failed or incomplete outputs.
10. Distribute reports that pass the agreed checks to approved recipients.
11. Log the final run status and notify support or finance of exceptions.

8. Business Rules

- Only finance-approved company codes, reports and reporting periods may be processed.
- Company-code mapping must come from the approved source; the bot must not infer or invent a mapping.
- A report must not be marked successful solely because a download or export action was triggered; output existence and basic validation must be checked.
- Reports that fail validation must be quarantined or marked for review and must not be distributed as final.
- File names must follow the agreed convention and identify the report, company code and reporting period.
- Recipients must be sourced from the approved distribution list, with access restricted according to data sensitivity.
- The bot must not modify source financial data or make accounting judgments.
- If a company code fails, the bot should continue with other codes where safe, while clearly identifying the partial completion.

9. Exceptions and Escalation

Scenario	Expected handling
Source system unavailable	Retry within the agreed limit, record the failure and alert support if unresolved.
Login or access failure	Stop protected actions, log a sanitized error and notify application support.
Company code missing from mapping	Skip that code and flag it for finance review.
Report generation fails	Record the company code and report name, then continue with other safe transactions.
Output file missing or empty	Mark the report as failed validation and do not

	distribute it as complete.
Duplicate output	Apply the agreed duplicate-handling rule and record the event.
Distribution fails	Keep the validated report in the approved secure location and notify support.
Unexpected screen or format change	Stop the affected step, capture permitted diagnostic details and raise an exception.

10. Assumptions and Dependencies

- Finance will provide the final report list, company-code list, reporting periods and validation rules.
- Authorized system access and appropriate automation permissions will be available.
- The current cycle-time baseline and target measurement method will be agreed before measuring the 50% improvement.
- The output repository, retention rules and report recipients will be approved before production.
- Source system changes, outages and data quality issues may affect the run and are not fully controlled by the bot.

11. Acceptance Criteria

- All in-scope reports and company codes are represented in the approved configuration.
- The bot retrieves the expected reports for test company codes and reporting periods.
- Company-code mapping and output naming follow finance-approved rules.
- Missing, empty or failed outputs are detected and excluded from final distribution.
- Only approved recipients receive reports, and outputs are stored in approved locations.
- The run log identifies processed company codes, outcomes, exceptions and delivery status.
- Cycle time is measured consistently against the agreed baseline, with the target of approximately 50% reduction evaluated using actual test or production results.

12. Items to Confirm Before Sign-off

- Source finance system(s), report names and exact navigation steps.
- Final list of company codes and mapping source.
- Reporting frequency, period parameters and schedule.
- Required validation checks and handling of partial runs.
- Output format, file naming convention and secure storage location.
- Distribution channel, recipients, approvals and retention policy.
- Baseline cycle time, measurement method and evidence required for the 50% improvement claim.